

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 3 2

♦ J 4

♣ Q J 10 4

♠ Q J 5

♥ K 5 4

♦ 10 9 7 3

♣ 8 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 6 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ K 7 5 3

♠ A 4

♥ A Q J 10 7 6

♦ A 5 2

♣ A 9

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

You are very close to the 22 points needed to open 2♣.

Of course close only counts in horse-shoes and hand grenades. So you open 1♥.

Partner responds 2♥.

This is a no-brainer. With partner showing 6-10 points you have plenty enough for game.

So you bid 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Well, you are **SUPPOSED** to have plenty of points for game. So why isn't it laydown? Answer: Because North has ♠ Q J instead of ♠ K. If he had ♠ K it would be a laydown.

So all you have to do is turn the ♠ Q J into the equivalent of the ♠ K. It's easy.

Win the ♣A. Take two rounds of trumps with the ♥A Q. East shows out on the second trump lead. Play the ♠A, then the ♠4. West will win the ♠K and the defense will take their ♣ trick. Then they must give you the lead and you play a ♥ to dummy's ♥K, pulling West's final trump. Play the good ♠Q, discarding one of your ♦ losers.

Admittedly it would have been simpler if North held the ♠K.

With the ♠ Q J instead you just have to take care with entries. (Make that entry, singular.)

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ K 10 4
♦ J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3 2

♠ K Q J 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K 7

♣ A 8 7 4



♠ 8 6 4

♥ A J 9 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 6 5

♠ A 10 9 7 3

♥ Q 7 6

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ Q

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
them anyway. If trumps split 2-2 then you can easily ruff both ♦ losers in dummy. Or, you could ruff three ♣ losers in your hand, it would work out the same.

The first key is to go up with the ♣ A. you cannot afford to lose a ♣ now with those three ♥ losers staring you in the face.

Next play the ♠ K and ♠ A, but West shows out on the second one. Don't pull a third one. You need to make those last five trumps separately. Take your two high ♦ s, then start cross-ruffing ♣ s and ♦ s. You will lose the final three ♥ s.

This is really a cross-ruff type plan.

And with any cross-ruff it is best to pull as many trumps as you can spare before you start ruffing. Leave yourself just the number of trumps you need.

You have a real bare-bones 13 points. No matter, you don't pass with 13. So you open 1 ♠.

Partner responds 2 ♣.

You have two choices - bid 2NT or bid 2 ♦. Neither is showing any extra strength so partner shouldn't go crazy. Not liking that singleton you say 2 ♦.

Partner goes crazy and bids 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣ J.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣ J.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

You may think you're lucky they didn't take their ♥ tricks, but the truth is that they will probably get

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ K 10 5 2
♦ Q 9 6
♣ J 10 8 2

♠ Q J

♥ A J 9 4

♦ K 8 4 3

♣ Q 6 5



♠ 7 5 2

♥ Q 7

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ A K 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6 3

♦ A 7

♣ 7 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

Two choices come to mind - 2NT or 2♥.

Of the two, 2♥ is better because it prevents a possible 4-4 ♥ fit from being lost. Partner rebids his ♠s.

Two opening hands equal one game. Since partner has 6 ♠ that game might as well be 4♠.

North would play 4♠.

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South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣J. They play two more high ♣s.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣J. They play two more high ♣s.

You ruff the third ♣, then play ♠Q and ♠J. Come to your hand with the ♦A and pull the last trump. Now decide what to do with the ♥s.

If West has both ♥K and ♥Q then a simple finesse of the ♥J will bring in the contract. This is only a 25% chance.

If the high ♥ honors are split, but West holds the ♥10 then a finesse of the ♥9 will force East to win with his high honor. You can return to your hand and then finesse West out of his other ♥ honor. This play has about a 50% chance of working so it is the one you should make.

This is called a Deep Finesse.

The only time it is a mistake is when West holds the ♥ K Q and East holds the ♥10. Even in that case though some Wests will "split their honors" and give it away.